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addiction and is a stimulant which makes the heart beat faster and the narrowing of blood vessels results in raised blood pressure and coronary heart diseases. Presence of carbon monoxide reduces oxygen supply. Lung cancer, cancer of the mouth and larynx is more common in smokers than non–smokers. Smoking also causes cancer of the stomach, pancreas and bladder and lowers sperm count in men.

Smoking can cause lung diseases by damaging the airways and alveoli and results in emphysema and chronic bronchitis. These two diseases along with asthma are often referred as Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD). When a person smokes, nearly 85% of the smoke released is inhaled by the smoker himself and others in the vicinity, called passive smokers, are also affected. Guidance or counselling should be done in such users to withdraw this habit.

AMAZING FACTS

- The World TB Day is March 24.
- Direct Observation Therapy (DOTs) can treat about 95% of the TB patients.
- The surface area of the lungs is roughly the same size as a tennis court (525 feet long).
- It is possible to live with one lung.
- The highest recorded 'sneeze speed' is 165 km per hour.
- Adults breathe around 12 – 16 times per minute where as new borns breathe around 30–60 times per minute.
- Yawning helps us to breathe more oxygen to the lungs. When our brain senses the shortage of O_2, it send a message to CNS to imbalance to O_2 demand and trigger us to yawn.
- Breathing through mouth results in bladder shrinkage and creates an urge to urinate in the middle of the night.
- Most people can hold their breath between 30 seconds to one minute.
- Hiccups are due to eating too fast or having occasional spasms of the diaphragm.

Activity

To test the presence of CO_2 in exhaled air Take two test tubes A and B with few mL of clear lime water. Blow exhaled air into A with a help of a straw and pass normal air into B with a help of a syringe for about 15 times and observe the changes that occur in the tubes A and B. The lime water (Calcium Hydroxide) in the test tube A turns milky.